

Erskine Advisory

Independent owner's representation for significant private residences.

WHAT WE DO

We act for private owners and family offices, representing their interests on significant residential construction projects. We review the contract before it is signed, verify claimed work against work actually in place before payments are released, administer change orders and the owner's statutory obligations, and report in a form the owner can act on. We are paid by the owner and by nobody else.

THE ONE SENTENCE, IF IT IS USEFUL

"They check that the work exists before your client pays for it — and they keep the holdback the Builders Lien Act requires, so your client isn't left funding their contractor's unpaid trades out of money they have already paid."

FROM THE ARCHITECT'S SIDE

What we absorb. Client management and the decision calendar. Payment application review against work in place. Change order logs and cost reporting. Owner questions that would otherwise arrive in your inbox at nine on a Sunday. On British Columbia projects, the owner's obligations under the Builders Lien Act — the 10% holdback (s.4(1)), the holdback account (s. 5), and the 45-day filing and 55-day holdback periods (s.20, s.8) — together with the title search before release, which is prudent practice rather than a statutory requirement.

What we never touch. Design authority. The aesthetic argument is yours, and we do not relitigate it with your client. We hold no opinion in front of an owner about a design decision that is properly the architect's.

What the role is built to do. Give the owner an independent reader, so that questions arrive earlier and decisions move forward rather than sideways. Put the numbers through a check before they are contested rather than after. And give an owner who needs to be told something they do not want to hear somebody other than you to hear it from.

INDEPENDENCE, CONDENSED

- We accept compensation from no one but our client. No referral fees, finder's fees, rebates or commissions — not disclosed-and-accepted, none.
- We hold no interest in any construction company. We do not build and we do not contract for construction work; the owner signs the construction contract directly with their licensed general contractor.
- No percentage of savings, and no contingency arrangement tied to outcomes.
- Specialists we retain — engineers, cost consultants, inspectors — are paid by us on the client's behalf, and have no relationship with the contractor.
- We will say when an owner does not need us, even though it costs us the fee.
- Everything is confidential by default. No client name, project or image is published without written permission.

The full commitment is published and dated at erskineadvisory.com/independence.

FEES

Fixed-fee pre-construction audit, \$25,000–60,000 by project scale. Full representation on a percentage of construction cost, stepping down as project size rises, or a monthly retainer. Advisory and recovery work at \$300–450 per hour, scoped in writing before it starts. Published at erskineadvisory.com/fees.

WHO WE ARE

Jesse Giddings and Geordie Flanagan, two equal partners. Available for engagements across North America; home base British Columbia. A small practice by design — the people you meet are the people doing the work.

FOR YOUR CLIENTS

Building in British Columbia: What the Owner Is Responsible For — a free guide to the obligations BC law places on owners, with the statutory section references throughout. Written to be useful to someone who never hires us. erskineadvisory.com/handbook

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The first conversation costs nothing, and if the answer is that your client does not need us, that is what they will hear.

Statutory references above describe what the legislation requires. They are not legal advice — interpretation on a specific project is a matter for a BC construction lawyer.